



Delaware County Council Meeting September 28th 2021

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=VlpPGYS_9no
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Target Category	delaware_county

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Delaware County Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: September 28, 2021

Location: Delaware Commissioners' Courtroom

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order:** The regular meeting of the Delaware County Council was called to order [00:00:16](#) by the presiding officer.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Mr. Ballard, Ms. Chambers (President), Ms. Lasseter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush, Mr. Webb, Mr. Alexander, Mr. Hughes.
 - **Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Ms. Chambers (President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:27](#).

- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Ballard) [00:01:30](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The August meeting minutes were approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Lasseter) [00:02:28](#).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

[00:03:00](#) Resolution 2021-035: Midwest Metal Tax Abatement

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Bookel, Delaware County Economic Development / Chad Smith (Company Representative).
- **Deliberation Summary:** The council considered a 10-year phased personal property tax abatement for Midwest Metal Products Company, Inc. (located at 3701 S. Cowan Road) for \$1.4 million in new equipment being brought from out of state. The company is celebrating its 100th anniversary, employs 145 workers (80% county residents), and maintains an average wage of \$17.35/hour. The tax abatement committee previously approved the request.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved unanimously by roll call vote (Motion: Ballard, Second: Piper) [00:08:57](#).

[00:09:45](#) Resolution 2021-034: Meadow Forge Solar Energy LLC (Invenergy) Tax Abatement & EDA Establishment

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Bookel / Tom Schroeder (Invenergy Representative).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Invenergy requested a 10-year phased personal property tax abatement for a \$155 million solar energy generation project (Meadow Forge Solar) spanning roughly 1,000 acres at 16500 N. 600 West in Gaston. The project will generate 163 megawatts of power (powering ~30,000 homes), create 150 temporary construction jobs, and 2 permanent operating roles at a minimum salary of \$52,000. The council established the underlying Economic Development Area (EDA) and scheduled a final confirmatory public hearing.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Ballard) [00:22:20](#). Public hearing for the confirmatory resolution officially set for October 26, 2021, at 9:00 AM [00:23:25](#).

[02:00:00](#) Resolution 2021-036: Hawthorne Solar LLC Tax Abatement

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brad Bookel / Adrian Markosic (Narenko Representative).
- **Deliberation Summary:** Hawthorne Solar LLC (a subsidiary of Narenko) requested a 10-year phased personal property tax abatement for an \$88 million, 75-megawatt utility-scale

solar project spanning approximately 355 acres in Delaware and Niles Townships (near State Road 28 and Albany). The project will create ~200 construction jobs and 2<U+2013>7 permanent positions with average salaries of \$60,000.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Ballard) 00:42:14. Public hearing set for October 26, 2021, at 9:00 AM 00:42:44.

Financial Transfers, Salary Ordinances, & General Appropriations

- **Statewide 911 (Overtime):** Transfer of \$15,000 from telephone to overtime. Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Ballard) 00:43:04.
- **Coroner Budget Adjustments:** Various line-item transfers totaling zero net request. Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Ballard) 00:45:37.
- **Commissioners (Health Insurance to Utilities):** Transfer of \$50,000. Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Web, Second: Piper) 00:46:48.
- **Commissioners (Veteran Service Officer):** Internal transfer of \$9,167.17. Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Chambers) 00:47:52.
- **Communications Center:** Transfer of \$3,000 for training. Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Ballard) 00:48:39.
- **4D Support:** Transfer of \$6,531.85. Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Ballard) 00:49:21.
- **Jail / Various Budget Corrections:** Multiple line-item transfers addressing salary roll-ins. Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Quakenbush) 00:50:41.
- **Public Defender:** Transfer of \$3,000 from investigative fees to office supplies. Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Ballard) 00:51:35.
- **Purdue Extension:** Lifted from table (Motion: Piper, Second: Webb) and approved transfer of \$1,587.46 for salary corrections (Motion: Piper, Second: Quakenbush) [00:52:13, 03:07:09].
- **GIS Map / Highway / Fairgrounds / Statewide 911 / Circuit Court / EMS:** Assorted routine operational transfers and addenda adjustments processed and approved by roll call votes.
- **Project Income Fund 2501 (Contract Monitoring):** Request for \$56,000 tabled after auditor reported the fund was operating in a deficit (01:15:46, Motion: Piper, Second: Webb).
- **01:28:54 American Rescue Plan (ARP) Funding Plan & Appropriations:**
 - **Presenter:** Joe / Commissioners.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council debated the proposed 2021 ARP funding allocation totaling an initial request of over \$8 million out of the county's total allocation. Discussions centered around tracking sub-recipients, reporting compliance mandated by the U.S. Treasury, administrative oversight, and individual

- projects including mental health facilities, regional wastewater upgrades (Oakville project removed during debate), and municipal water/sewer extensions.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved as amended (totaling \$7,902,000 across specific line items after removing the Oakville sewer project) by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Ballard) [02:51:17](#). (Note: Ms. Lasseater voted nay).
 - **Financial Transfers & Salary Ordinance Amendment:** Omnibus approval of financial transfer agenda and salary ordinance adjustments. Approved by roll call vote (Motion: Piper, Second: Ballard) [02:53:45](#).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [02:58:42](#) **Rick Yetzer:** Voiced strong opposition to the lack of a statutory public hearing specifically advertised for the federal ARP stimulus plan, criticized the focus on infrastructure over direct aid to citizens, and questioned funding allocations for private building roofs and out-of-county wastewater lines.
 - [03:00:53](#) **Corporal Messick (Correctional Officer):** Spoke passionately regarding severe staff shortages, high stress, exposure to health hazards, and extreme pay disparities between correctional staff and other county highway or municipal workers starting at much higher base rates.
 - [03:04:29](#) **Detective Mitch Corey (Sheriff's Department):** Highlighted the critical pay gap for deputies and correctional officers compared to neighboring counties (such as Madison County or Muncie PD paying ~\$12,000 more), warned of ongoing staff attrition, and criticized the council for providing an across-the-board \$1,000 raise viewed as insufficient.
 - [03:08:41](#) **Captain Tony Johnson (Sheriff's Department):** Compared administrative salary increases authorized for newly structured departments (such as Convention and Tourism directors) against the heavily burdened leadership roles in the jail and sheriff's department, urging the council to revalue high-risk public safety positions.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Board Announcements:** Library board vacancy announced for Yorktown; interested residents residing within Yorktown for the past two years were instructed to contact council members.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by voice vote / roll call following a motion by Ballard and second by Piper [02:34:43](#).
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